Interview & Role-Play Question Bank

Companion to **File 1 (3-Month Program)**. Use these in Session B/C role-plays. **How to use:** pick 8–10 questions per round. Mix the order. Add follow-ups (→). Change speed and "personality" (friendly / neutral-fast / serious).

Teacher rule: never give the student a memorized answer to repeat. Help them build **their own true answer**, short and clear. Real officers detect memorized speeches.

1. Airport immigration / passport control

Opening:

- Good morning. Passport, please.
- Where are you coming from? / Where did you fly in from?
- Is this your first time in the United States / in Canada / in the UK?

Purpose & stay:

- What's the purpose of your visit? / Business or pleasure?
- How long are you planning to stay? → Why that long?
- When are you going back? → Do you have a return ticket? Can I see it?
- Where are you staying? → What's the address? → Who's paying for the hotel?
- What are you going to do here? → Which cities are you visiting?

People:

- Are you traveling alone? → Who's that with you?
- Do you know anyone here? → What does your son/daughter do here? → Is he/she a citizen?
- Are you visiting family?

Home ties (proof you'll go back):

- What do you do in Brazil? → How long have you worked there?
- Are you retired? → What did you do before?
- Do you own a house in Brazil? → Do you have family there?

Money & customs:

- How much money are you carrying? → Do you have a credit card?
- Are you bringing any food, plants or animals? → Any meat, cheese, fruit?
- Anything to declare? / Are you carrying more than $10,000?

- What's in this bag?

Closing (listening):

- *Look at the camera, please. / Put your right hand fingers here. Now your thumb.*
- *Enjoy your stay. / Welcome to the United States. / You're all set.*

Officer personalities for practice:

- **Friendly:** smiles, slow, short interview (2 min).
- **Neutral-fast:** no smile, very fast, 10 questions in 2 minutes.
- **Serious:** follow-up on every answer, asks for documents, silence pauses (students must not fill the silence with nervous talk).

2. Visa interview (consulate) — practice version

> **Honest note for students:** at US consulates in Brazil, the interview is often available in Portuguese — confirm when scheduling. Practice in English anyway: it builds confidence and prepares for the airport, where the conversation *will* be in English. Always tell the truth; consistency with the application form (DS-160 for the US) is what matters.

- Why do you want to go to the United States?
- Have you ever been to the US before? → When? How long did you stay?
- Have you ever been refused a visa?
- Who's going with you?
- Who is paying for your trip?
- What do you do for a living? → How much do you earn per month?
- Are you married? → Does your spouse work? → Is he/she traveling with you?
- Do you have children? → Where do they live?
- Do you have relatives in the US? → What is their immigration status?
- What will you do after your trip?

3. Hotel / accommodation

- Hi, welcome. Checking in? → Can I have your name? → Can I see your ID and a credit card?
- How many nights? / How many guests?
- Would you like to upgrade to a room with a view for $30 more?
- Breakfast is from 7 to 10 in the lobby restaurant. / Your room is on the 5th floor, the elevator is on your right.
- **Problem cards (student must call the front desk):** no hot water · neighbors are noisy · room not clean · AC broken · wrong room type (they booked a double, got a single) · charged twice on the

card.

4. Restaurant / café

- Hi! How many? / Do you have a reservation?
- Can I get you something to drink to start?
- Are you ready to order, or do you need a few more minutes?
- How would you like that cooked? / Which side would you like — fries, salad, or mashed potatoes?
- Any allergies I should know about?
- How is everything? / Can I get you anything else?
- Are you still working on that? / Do you want a box for that?
- Would you like to see the dessert menu?
- Together or separate checks?
- **Problem cards:** wrong dish · food is cold · there's a hair in the soup · the bill is wrong · you're vegetarian and there's meat in it.

5. Getting around

- Where to? (taxi/Uber) → Which entrance? → Is here OK?
- (Station) Where are you heading? → One-way or round trip? → That'll be $12.50.
- (Car rental) Do you want full coverage insurance? / Will anyone else be driving? / Please return it with a full tank.
- (Stranger) You look lost — can I help you?
- **Problem cards:** the Uber didn't show up · wrong stop · the train is canceled · you got a parking ticket · flat tire.

6. Doctor / pharmacy / emergency

- What seems to be the problem? / What brings you in today?
- When did it start? → Is it getting better or worse?
- On a scale from 1 to 10, how bad is the pain?
- Are you taking any medication? → Any allergies?
- Do you have travel insurance? → Can I see the card?
- (Pharmacy) Do you have a prescription? / Take one pill twice a day with food.
- (Police) What happened? → When and where? → Can you describe the person? → What was in the bag?

- (Lost luggage) Can I see your baggage claim tag? → Can you describe the bag? → Where can we deliver it?

7. Small talk with strangers

- So, where are you from? → Oh, Brazil! I've always wanted to go. What's it like?
- Is this your first time here? → How do you like it so far?
- What do you do? / Are you here on vacation?
- How long are you in town for?
- Have you tried the ___ here yet? You have to!
- What's the best place to visit in Brazil? → Is it safe? → What's the food like?
- Do you speak Spanish? *(expect this one — many think Brazilians speak Spanish)*
- Are you a soccer fan?

8. Telling stories & opinions (Phase 3)

- How was your trip? What was the best part? What was the worst part?
- Tell me about your hometown. How has it changed?
- What did you do for work? What did you like about it?
- What's the most beautiful place you've ever been to?
- If you could live anywhere, where would you live? Why?
- Do you prefer traveling with a group or on your own?
- What do you think about ___ (food in the US / big cities / technology)?
- What's something you've always wanted to do but never did?

9. Bonus: job interview in English (for students who need it)

> Some students will want this. Add 2–4 sessions on top of the program if needed.

- Tell me about yourself. *(the 60-second "My Story" — they've been building it since Week 1!)*
- Why are you interested in this position?
- What are your strengths? / What's one weakness?
- Tell me about a time you solved a difficult problem. *(use the STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result)*

- Why did you leave your last job?
- Where do you see yourself in five years?
- Do you have any questions for us? *(they must always have 2!)*